MIL-P-43948A
31 December 1986
SUPERSEDING
MIL-P-43948
24 June 1976

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PILLOW BED: POLYESTER FILLED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers a polyester filled bed pillow of one type and size.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents.

* 2.1.1 Documents. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-276	-	Thread, Cotton
CCC-C-436	-	Cloth, Ticking Twill, Cotton
DDD-L-20	-	Label: For Clothing, Equipage and Tentage (General Use)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 7210

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MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods
FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.4).

3.2 Materials.

* 3.2.1 Ticking. The cotton ticking shall conform to type I, class 1 style a or b (see 6.2) of CCC-C-436.

3.2.2 Filling. The filling shall be of virgin (as defined in the Textile Fiber Product Identification Act) polyester fiber formed into an even batt of an approved fiberfill material (see 6.3). The use of any form of polyester waste is prohibited. e.g. undrawn fiber, a mixture of deniers (tex), lusters or cross sections, and waste from any stage of fiber production; whether drawn, undrawn or mixed or garnetted fiber. The use of airblown or garnetted clippings is prohibited. A certificate of compliance is mandatory for the above filling requirement and it shall include: A certified statement that the fiber used is that specified herein, along with the contractor's type and identification data supported by a certified copy of the fiber producer's certification to the manufacturer of pillows.

3.2.3 Thread. The thread utilized in the fabrication of the pillows shall be ticket No. 30, 3 ply. type IA1 (unbleached) or type IA2 (white) conforming to V-T-276 except that the looper thread shall be ticket No. 50, 3 ply when the 401 stitch is used.

3.3 Sizes and weights. The pillows shall be rectangular in shape and shall conform to the finished dimensions and weights specified in table I.

TABLE I. Pillow size and weight

Width 1/	20 ± 1/2 inches
Length 1/	26 ± 1/2 inches
Total weight:	
Minimum	27 ounces
Maximum	31 ounces
Weight of filling:	
Minimum	20 ounces
Maximum	22 ounces

1/ Length and width of filled and closed pillow shall be measured from end of seam to end of seam. This shall be accomplished after placement of the pillow on a flat level surface, the pillow surfaces smoothened, and the seam

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lines straightened so that they are extended to the fullest in natural direction in which the measurement is to be taken.

3.4 Construction. Pillows shall be made of one piece of ticking with the stripes in the widthwise direction (shorter direction) of the pillow. The case shall be seamed inside-out leaving one end open. The end opening shall be seamed after turning the case right side out and filling the pillow (see 3.4.2). Stitching shall be not less than 1/4 inch from the edges of the material except that stitching on final closure shall be not less than 1/8 inch from the edge. One end of the identification label and instruction label shall be securely stitched into the closing seam or the seam opposite the closing seam of the pillow. When separate state label is legally required by the state in which the pillow is manufactured, the state label shall be securely stitched adjacent to and in the same seam as the identification label.

3.4.1 Stitches, seams, and stitchings. Stitches, seams, and stitchings shall conform to the requirements of FED-STD-751. All stitches except closing seam shall be stitch type 301 or type 401. The closing seam shall be stitch type 301. Stitches per inch shall be not less than 8 and not more than 10. All seams, except closing seam, shall be seam type SSa-1. The 301 stitch, when not caught in other seams and stitching, shall be backtacked not less than 1/4 inch. Both ends of all seams and stitching produced with 401 stitch type, when not caught in other seams or stitching, shall have a 1/2 inch minimum length chain extending beyond each end. Thread breaks (all stitch types) shall be secured by stitching back of the break not less than 1 inch. Skipped stitches or thread breaks (401 stitch type) may be repaired by using type 301 stitch. Seam allowances shall be maintained with seams properly sewn so that no raw edges, runoffs, twists, pleats, puckers, or open seams will result.

3.4.2 Filling the pillow case. A funnel shaped compression chute or suitable mechanical means shall be used to place the fiberfill batt (see 3.2.2) into the casing. The use of a blower attachment for placing the fiberfill into the casing is prohibited. Underweight batts shall not be pieced in.

* 3.5 Labels: Each pillow shall have attached a label conforming to the legal requirements of the state in which the pillow is manufactured, a class 4 combination identification and size label or a state legal requirement label combined with a class 4 identification and size label if permitted by state regulation, and a class 3 instruction label conforming to type VI of DDD-L-20. The state legal requirements, combination identification and size, and instruction labels may be combined into one label if state regulations permit. The label shall be colorfast to laundering in accordance with DDD-L-20. The instruction label content shall be as follows:

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CARE INSTRUCTIONS

Launder and dry by Formula G of FM-10-17

Tumble dry at 130° to 150°F (54° to 66°C) until dry

* 3.6 Workmanship. The pillows shall conform to the quality of product established by this document and the occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.1.2 Certificates of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3, 4.4.4, and 4.4.5. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

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* 4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.4.2 In-process inspection.

4.4.2.1 Filling of pillows. Inspection shall be made during the filling of the pillows to determine whether the operation is accomplished as specified in 3.4.2. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material or service for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance.

4.4.2.2 Unfilled cases. The unfilled cases shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in units of cases. The sample unit shall be one case turned inside out. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

TABLE II. Unfilled case defects

Examine	Defect
Construction and workmanship	Not stitch type specified
	Not seam type specified
	Less than 8 stitches per inch
	More than 10 stitches per inch
	Any open seam
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken, or when two or more consecutive skipped or runoff stitches occur.
	Stripes not in widthwise direction
	Stitching less than 1/4 inch from edge of material
	Loose tension resulting in a loose seam
	Tight tension (stitches break when normal pull tension is applied)

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TABLE II. Unfilled case defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect
Construction and workmanship (cont'd)	Stitching irregular or uneven, resulting in badly twisted, pleated, or bulging seams
	Ends of seams produced with 301 stitch type (when not caught in other seams or stitching) backtacked less than 1/4 inch
	Ends of seams produced with 401 stitch type (when not caught in other seams or stitching) not having chain extending beyond each end, or having chain extending less than 1/2 inch beyond each end
	Any thread break not backstitched a minimum of 1 inch

4.4.2.3 Weight of unfilled ticking cases. A determination for average weight of ticking cases shall be made for each lot (for use in calculating the weight of fiberfill in the finished pillows, see 4.4.4.2). The average case weight shall be taken as the average weight obtained from weighing not less than 100 cases in the lot.

4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table III. The lot size shall be expressed in units of pillows. The sample unit shall be one pillow. The inspection level shall be II and the AQL, expressed in terms of defect per hundred units, shall be 1.5 for major defects and 4.0 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE III. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Quality of material	Any hole, cut, tear, or mend	X	
	Any smash	X	
	Abrasion mark, tender or weak place	X	
	Broken or missing yarns, two or more contiguous	X	
	Crack, clearly visible 1/	X	
	Slub, more than three times the thickness of normal yarns		X
	Any spot, stain, or streak, clearly visible 1/		X

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TABLE III. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Cleanness	Untrimmed thread ends on exterior of pillow, fiberfill not removed throughout outside of pillow		X
	Offensive or objectionable odor	X	
Construction and workmanship (of closing seam only)	Formation of lumps	X	
	Loose tension resulting in loose seam	X	
	Tight tension (stitches break when normal pull tension is applied)	X	
	Ends of seams produced with 301 stitch type (when not caught in other seams or stitching) back-tacked less than 1/4 inch		X
	Stitching irregular or uneven, resulting in badly twisted, pleated, or bulging edges	X	
	Any thread break not backstitched a minimum of 1 inch		X
	Any open seam	X	
NOTE:	A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches are broken, or when two or more consecutive skipped or runoff stitches occur.		
	Wrong seam or stitch type:		
	-seriously affecting serviceability	X	
	-affecting serviceability but not seriously		X
	Raw edge over 1/2 inch in length	X	
	Raw edge over 1/4 inch up to and including 1/2 inch in length		X
NOTE:	Raw edge not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as open seam		

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TABLE III. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
	Two or more stitches per inch less or more than required	X	
	One stitch per inch less or more than required		X
	Covering spliced or not fabricated of one piece of material	X	
	Row of stitching less than 1/8 inch from edge		X
Label or labels	Missing, incorrect, illegible, or not securely attached		X

1/ At normal inspection distance (approximately 3 feet).

4.4.4 Weight examination. Weights, as required in 4.4.2.3, 4.4.4.1, and 4.4.4.2 shall be determined, recorded, and calculated to the nearest 1 ounce. In the event of dispute, the samples shall be conditioned to constant weight ± 0.25 ounce under standard conditions as defined in FED-STD-191, and the results obtained on the conditioned samples shall be considered final.

4.4.4.1 Total weight. The end item shall be examined for weight. Any weight less than the minimum or more than the maximum total weight specified in table I shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of pillows. The sample unit shall be one pillow. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

4.4.4.2 Weight of fiberfill. The end item shall be examined for weight of the fiberfill filling. The weight of the fiberfill shall be calculated by subtracting the average weight of the ticking cases (see 4.4.2.3) from the total weight of the pillow. Any filling calculated to weigh less than the minimum or more than the maximum specified in table I shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of pillows. The sample unit shall be one pillow. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

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* 4.4.5 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for the dimensions listed in table I. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of pillows. The sample unit shall be one pillow. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

* 4.4.6 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete sealing or closure of container flap. improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling. Open and non-continuous heat-sealed seams and closure of polyethylene bag. Incorrectly fabricated bag. Provisions for escape of air not as specified. Bulged or distorted container.
Contents	Number of pillows per shipping container is more or less than required.

* 4.4.7 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

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Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PACKAGING

* 5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Level A. Each pillow shall be inserted in a close-fitting clear polyethylene film bag having a thickness of 0.00125 inch ± 25 percent tolerance. The bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight, continuous, and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. The final closure of the bag shall be heat sealed with the heat seal made as close as possible to the open end. The bag may be fabricated from polyethylene film tubing or sheeting. Open vents of approximately 1 inch at each side of the closure or a 1/2 inch hole in each of the opposite corners of the bag shall be provided for the escape of excess air. Alternatively, the final closure of the bag shall be accomplished by folding over and securing the open end of the bag body with pressure-sensitive tape.

* 5.1.2 Commercial. Pillows shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

* 5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A packing. Six pillows, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Level A unit packs shall be packed flat, six in depth within the shipping container. Inside dimensions of each container shall approximate 22 inches in length, 17-3/4 inches in width, and 22-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Prior to closure of the shipping container, sufficient compression shall be applied to the pillows to insure proper closure of the container. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6. Shipping containers shall be

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arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II class F loads.

* 5.2.2 Level B packing. Six pillows, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A unit packs shall be packed flat, six in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each container shall approximate 22 inches in length, 17-3/4 inches in width, and 22-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Prior to closure of the shipping container, sufficient compression shall be applied to the pillows to insure proper closure of the container. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6.

* 5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant container. When specified (see 6.2), the fiberboard shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6.

* 5.2.3 Commercial packing. Pillows preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

* 5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), pillows packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet types shall be type I (4-way entry), types IV or V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with the bonding means K and L or film bonding means O and P. Pallet pattern shall be numbered 6 in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The pillows are primarily intended for use as bed pillows.

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* 6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article sample is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.4).
c. When style a ticking is required (see 3.2.1).
d. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.2.1).
f. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
g. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

* 6.3 Fiberfill material. Approval of fiberfill material is the responsibility of the US Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014. Approval is based on extensive tests and evaluations which are not set forth in the document. The following products are currently approved:

a. Celanese - Fortrel 7 Fiberfill
b. Du Pont - Dacron Fiberfill II H
c. Eastman - Kodel Fiberfill 233

6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Pillow
Bed
Polyester
Fiberfill

6.6 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document have been marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-P-43948A	Pillow Bed Polyester Filled

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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